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Kraft, Foxborough wrangle once more

Patriots, family firm sue town over licensing deal, reignite bitter dispute

By Chris Serres
and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

On the eve of New England's second World Cup match, a fresh dispute between the town of Foxborough and the Kraft family company that owns Gillette Stadium has thrown cold water on a rare mo-

ment of harmony, coming just as months of pre-tournament feuding seemed to be settled.

On Monday, Kraft Sports and Entertainment LLC and the New England Patriots sued the town, accusing Foxborough officials of improperly squeezing them for nearly \$1 million in new licensing fees that are

not authorized under state law.

The lawsuit reanimates a bitter, long-running rift between the Kraft family company and the town where Gillette Stadium is located, which for a brief period in March cast doubt on whether the World Cup would even happen here. It also suggests the finger-pointing, delays, and logistical headaches that marred Boston's early World Cup preparations are not truly settled — and can boil over at any time.

"Everything finally appeared to be going in the right direction — the focus was on the pitch and how people were celebrating and embracing the beautiful game," said Pat Moscaritolo, the former head of the Greater Boston Convention & Visitors Bureau who helped bring the 1994 games here. "And now, boom, they drop this? It's perplexing, to say the least."

The 52-page suit, filed in Norfolk Superior Court before Iraq and Nor-

KRAFT, Page A7

NOW BOARDING AT NORSE STATION



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Rune Karlsen sang along to a chant played by Rune Tribune Plauinb as they waited in South Station to board a train to take them to Norway's World Cup match against Iraq. It was the first match played on a workday, but fans said the transit was smooth. "It's been seamless, well-run, so far no issue," said Amanda Robertson, a Norway fan from Hingham. **Game, C1.**

They fell in love in college. They married in his hospice room.

A lifetime together, compressed in a series of treasured moments

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

On April 15, exactly eight years after Robbie Fox and Kelli Peters met during their freshman year at Elon University in North Carolina, their closest relatives gathered in Boston for their wedding.

The ceremony was intimate, with just seven people nestling them in a world all their own. Soft waves of brunette hair framed her face; he was clad in dark gray. They clasped hands as they exchanged vows, and the tearful guests burst into applause when they were pronounced husband and wife.

Peters leaned over Fox's hospital bed and the 27-year-olds shared a tender kiss, beginning a married life they knew would be tragically brief.

Three days earlier, Fox had moved into hospice care at Brigham and Women's Hospital after his aggressive bone cancer took a devastating turn.

It was a journey that had begun two years before, when Fox, in the midst of endurance training for a Half Ironman triathlon, took a hard fall on his bike. Fearing he had broken a bone, he got it checked out, he recalled in an essay about the experience. Instead, a scan revealed multiple tumors. He was diagnosed



Robbie Fox and Kelli Peters at Brigham and Women's Hospital on June 10, 2024.

with Ewing sarcoma and given about a 60 percent survival rate.

Peters and Fox were deeply in love and had planned a future together, perhaps in New England. But Fox said he would understand if she wanted to end it.

WEDDING, Page A7

Key group backs deal on rent control

Fuels effort to
avert fight over
ballot question

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

It was only a few years ago when the major property owners in the region collectively took up arms over Mayor Michelle Wu's relatively modest proposal to reintroduce rent control in Boston.

A rent cap of any sort, they warned, could wreck Boston's rental market, lead to neglect and disinvestment in current apartments, and disrupt the pipeline of new homes. Some housing developers threatened to leave Boston altogether.

How much can change in a few short years.

One of the most powerful real estate lobbies in the state, NAIOP Massachusetts, this week said it is now ready to negotiate a form of rent stabilization in order to head off a far more restrictive cap statewide that is slated to go before voters in November.

In a message to members, the trade group's chief executive, Tamara Small, said that while the organization still has many concerns about how rent control would affect housing construction and affordability, NAIOP was coming to the table "in good

RENT, Page A6

Deal seeks to overhaul lessons on reading

Would rely on phonics,
increase state oversight

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

A long-running debate over how schoolchildren are taught to read in Massachusetts may soon be settled: Phonics is set to become the law of the land.

In an effort to reverse a decade-long decline in reading skills, Massachusetts lawmakers on Tuesday announced a deal to overhaul literacy instruction for the state's youngest learners, imposing mandates on schools that would end the see-sawing between two different approaches.

While earlier versions of the measure has been opposed by the Massachusetts Teachers Association, lawmakers contend they have to act now to stop a decade-long decline in student achievement.

If the deal is approved, educators starting in the fall of 2027 would be required to use "evidence-based" literacy instruction that includes teaching children to sound out words, vocabulary building, oral comprehension, and more.

It would also prohibit literacy curriculums that rely on "cueing" — which instructs children to, for example, look at a picture and guess what an unknown word means based on contextual clues.

A 2023 Globe investigation found nearly half of school districts in the state used curriculums that were dubbed "low quality" by the state, in part because the education plans taught cueing to stu-

READING, Page A5

Urge to leave Mass. prevalent

Voters in poll cite high cost
of living, taxes as reasons
to seek out new horizons

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

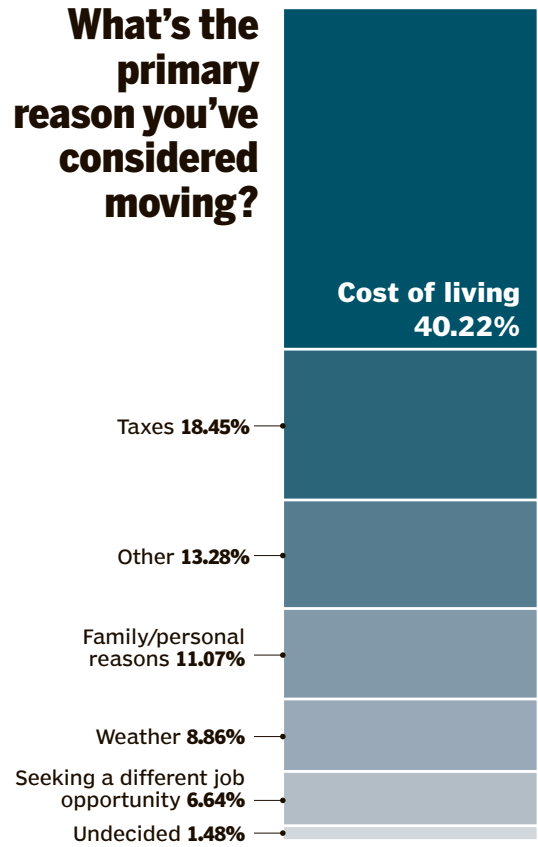
In the next few months, Caitlin Burns will likely be an example of a trend Massachusetts politicians have long feared: a young person fleeing the state for a cheaper cost of living elsewhere.

"The idea that I will live somewhere without a roommate in the near future does not seem particularly likely in this state," said Burns, a 31-year-old financial analyst who moved from Florida in 2019 seeking more liberal views and less swampy summers. She is now looking to New Hampshire or Vermont, while her current roommate, she added, is headed home to Michigan — also to escape Massachusetts' high costs.

Burns is among the more than half of those surveyed in a new Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll who said they've weighed leaving Massachusetts in the last year, with most pointing to the cost of living or taxes as the reason.

Roughly one in four of the 500 registered voters polled said they've "seriously considered" a move

POLL, Page A6



SOURCE: Suffolk University/Boston Globe. Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll of 271 registered voters in Massachusetts conducted between June 8 and June 12 via mobile and landline. CHRISTINA PRIGNANO/GLOBE STAFF

Connecting the delectable dots

A tasty social media sensation — dot cakes — is inspiring Boston-area bakeries to create their own versions. **G1.**

The final days of school for many Boston students feel like an oven, with temperatures in classrooms averaging 100 degrees. **B1.**

Officials warned that the Ebola outbreak could significantly worsen, infecting thousands of Africans. **A3.**

A robotic hand developed by a Northeastern graduate helps deaf and blind people communicate, writes Hia-watha Bray. **B5.**

Iran insisted its deal with the US requires Israel to leave Lebanon. **A4.**

On the ray out

Wednesday: A few clouds move in. High 75-80, low 60-65.

Thursday: Morning rain, afternoon storm. High 74-79, low 65-70.

Weather and comics, **G6-7.**
Obituaries, **C9.**



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